



Apple wins new patents

Apple won 34 new patent claims, including ones for Apple TV, 3D apps on the iPhone, and videoconferencing

OLED TVs delayed

Manufacturing issues have caused delays, leading Samsung and LG to postpone the launches of their next-gen OLED TVs to 2013

The keyboard is comfortable to use, although it has a slightly spongy feel. Critically, key size is perfect, and that can compensate for the lack of chunky feel from the keys. Despite the optical drive on one side, all connectivity ports are accommodated on its side, rather than on the backside of its spine.

If you want your ultrabook to stand out in a crowd, then look no further than the Toshiba Satellite U840w. While traditional laptop displays are now 16:9, this one has a wider aspect ratio of 21:9. The lid has a two toned brushed dark gold and black finish with an imprint design. Open it up and the same tone extends onto the keyboard deck as well. Apart from the wider form factor, the element that catches your attention is the placement of the speakers on the left and the right side of the keyboard – the extra space is used well. The palmrest area is lesser in terms of depth, and if you do a lot of typing, then this won't help. However, this ultrabook works well for multimedia

put together. Keyboard is slightly more spaced out than on most ultrabooks, which is nice.

The Acer's Aspire S3 looks and feels less expensive than it actually is, unfortunately. This feeling has been amplified by the better built alternatives available with more affordable price tags. There is no taking away the fact that it looks very sophisticated, but it doesn't have the visual pull you expect from a device that you have paid so much for. Its minimalistic design works well with the slightly unique colour - mixture of grey, gold and light brown. Its brushed metal finish was unique at launch, but it's very common with ultrabooks now. However, there is no denying the fact that the Aspire S3 is very slim, more towards the front than the back. It's very solidly built and the chassis doesn't flex at any point. Despite being very slim, its key travel and feel hasn't been sacrificed. A



HP Envy 4 Ultrabook

with the red on its lid. Its magnesium build has absolutely no rough edges or flex and it is without doubt one of the smartest looking ultrabooks in the market. But its keypad is a disappointment. The keys are slightly thinner horizontally than the standard size across ultrabooks, and the travel is just not adequate. To top it off, we did not like the spongy feel offered while typing. The Enter key is redesigned, and that bigger size takes time getting used to. This ultrabook has the thinnest frame around the display, very similar to the Samsung Series 9.

The Dell XPS 14 builds on the brilliance of the XPS 13, with a design that stands out. The device's minimalistic looks and premium feel is unique. There are three materials used on its chassis – aluminum, magnesium and silicon. The lid is made of aluminum and the keyboard deck has magnesium with a soft feel finish. Flip the XPS 14 over and its bottom has a layer of silicon that prevents heat from reaching your skin when using it on the lap. Generous cooling vents is something we had appreciated in the XPS 13, and that has been carried forward here as well. This ultrabook isn't as thin as you would expect, and the dimensions have more in common with a MacBook Pro than a MacBook Air, but it attracts a lot of attention.

The 14-inch display has a 1600 x 900 pixel resolution but the advantages of that are somewhat lost by its reflective nature.

The Samsung Series 9 at its thickest point is 12.9mm, while the MacBook Air tips 17.2mm at its thickest point. But the slimmer profile of the ultrabook didn't stop Samsung from fitting an

assortment of I/O ports on its side. The chassis is claimed to be 100 per cent aluminum, and looking at the overall package, we think that claim is well justified. Materials used are premium, and critically, the display hinge tautness is among the best, if not the very best. Its mineral ash black colour is rather rare. The overall design of the Samsung Series 9 is very good. Open it up and you will notice the slim bezel. The keyboard layout hasn't been compromised in any way, keyboard responds accurately and precisely, like a well oiled engine. The ultrabook's key travel and typing experience is unaffected by its slimmer profile. It is the built ultrabook in the comparison test.



Dell XPS 14 Ultrabook

viewing. Although it can't be slipped in a bag easily, it's well built, with no flex on the chassis. The finish on the ASUS S56CA's lid and keyboard deck isn't as dark as the Samsung Series 5 or the Toshiba Satellite U840. The S56CA's bezel is slightly thicker, housing its 15.6-inch display. Despite being big, it remains very slim and still packs in an optical drive. Materials used are fairly good quality and feel well

bigger than expected touchpad area is another strong point.

The Fujitsu Lifebook U772 sincerely surprised us with its good build quality and the overall premium feel. This is an ultrabook aimed at the demographic that traditionally buy a business laptop - the likes of the Lenovo ThinkPad, HP ProBook or the Dell Vostro. The U772's matte black finish on the rest of the chassis combines well

FEATURES, SPECS & PERFORMANCE

Category 1: The common processor across this category is the Core i5-3317U processor. There is 4GB of RAM to help the performance. Among this category, the Inspiron 14z is behind the Acer Timeline Ultra M5 in terms of system performance, and pretty much at par with the Toshiba Satellite U840 and the Sony Vaio T11. However, this is the only ultrabook to offer dedicated graphics. The AMD Radeon 7570M (1GB) shows fairly good mid-range performance. Tested battery